

would not be able to silence her. On the contrary, such acts will only increase the popularity of the writer.

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, *Kolkata*

Learn a Lesson

The vast exodus of students wanting to study abroad must be plugged ("Left High and Dry", August 27). Some of them return with degrees commanding no market value. Our potential to attract foreign students should be widened through tie-ups with reputed international institutes.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

123 of Finance

Though the magazine has proved to be a great help in matters of financial planning, the tips it gives out, should be more in line with the middle class which bears the brunt of income tax, fringe benefit tax as well as price rise ("Financial Mistakes We Make", August 27).

BHASKAR RAO, *Ranchi*

No Coaching, Please

Our team has now learnt the art of playing its natural game ("The Art of Turnaround", August 27). BCCI should dump the idea of recruiting a coach as we are used to playing cricket in a free environment, which is not possible with a coach.

NEELAM BHATIA, *Delhi*

History in Ruins

Nothing is being done to revive or maintain the ancient monuments of India which carry a valuable piece of our history, architecture and culture ("Regal

Revival", August 27). Thousands of such forgotten historical structures have been left to decay. It is only those monuments which can bring in revenue that interest the government.

ANJANA CHOWDHURY, *Kolkata*

Photo Finish

It is unfair on the magazine's part to show the new President in a poor light on any issue, however trivial ("Picture Imperfect", August 27).

A photograph that does not show her complete face cannot adorn the offices of the Central government in the country and abroad.

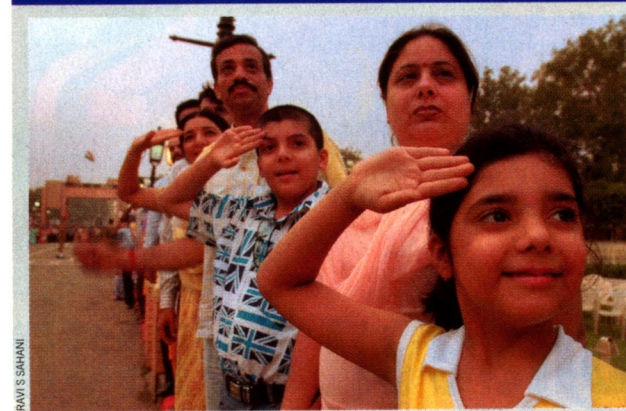
P.M. RAVINDRAN, *Kalpathy*

Gandhi: A Failed Father

One just cannot fathom the reason why Gandhi is called the Father of the Nation when he failed to be a good father to his own children ("From Saint to Star", August 20).

P. GURU RAJA, *Bangalore*

SINGULAR IDENTITY



It is premature to gloat over our unity ("What Unites India", August 20). Sixty years is a small fraction in a nation's history. Unless we are able to produce leaders with a vision and a mission, we may well go the Bangladesh-Pakistan way.

T. SANTHANAM, *Chennai*

The magazine forgot to mention one major unifying force of India—the media. The news media keeps us united by giving out pieces of information and reminding us of what being an Indian means.

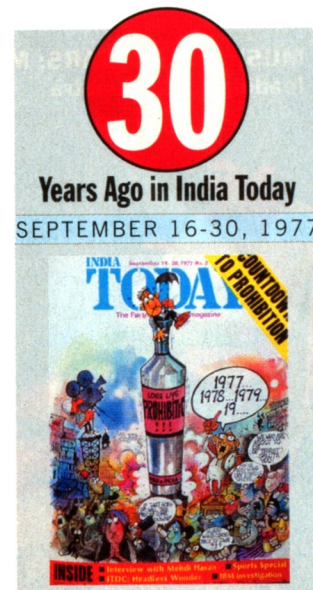
DEEPESH NAMBIAR, *on e-mail*

The kind of secularism that the magazine is propagating smacks of hypocrisy. Even after 60 years of Independence, Hindus are still being punished for being in majority in their homeland.

BIKAS DAS, *Balasore*

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

e-mail your letters to: letters.editor@intoday.com
or fax them to: 011-23316180



King of Ghazals

Through two wars and more than a decade of strained relations between India and Pakistan, the Mehdi Hasan following in India has steadily grown. The 44-year-old Hasan has been something more than a myth for Indians. Excerpts from an interview:

On Lata Mangeshkar:

She is the queen of music and there is nobody to touch her.



Mehdi Hasan

On India: I have invitations from several people to visit India. But official reasons have kept me from doing so.

On his musical training: I belong to the sixteenth generation of professional singers. My forefathers were part of the Jaipur *gharana* of music.

On classical music: There is something eternal about classical traditions of music. Fast music, in my opinion, is short-lived because it is superficial.

—Qutubuddin